

The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, MAY 1, 2025

‘Vermonters: I’ve always learned that home is where you feel safe and loved. And those who surround you, they are your people. And you are my people.’

MOHSEN MAHDAWI, *speaking on his release*

Mahdawi freed from custody

Judge references McCarthyism as he orders Columbia student be released



AMANDA SWINHART/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Mohsen Mahdawi spoke outside the Burlington, Vt., courthouse after a judge released him on Wednesday.

By John R. Ellement, Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, and Shelley Murphy

GLOBE STAFF

Mohsen Mahdawi, one of the international students who say they were targeted by the Trump administration for their criticism of Israel and in support of Palestinians, was released on bail Wednesday by a federal judge in Vermont who likened the government’s actions in his case to McCarthyism.

US District Court Judge Geoffrey W. Crawford ordered Mahdawi, 34, released from Immigration and Customs Enforcement custody while the court considers legal issues he has raised under the First Amendment protection of free speech and due process rights.

Mahdawi’s lawyers argued that he was detained for deportation proceedings solely because he participated in the high-profile protests in support of Palestinians

at Columbia University, where he was a student. He was arrested on April 14 on his way to a citizenship interview in Colchester, Vt.

“Immigration detention cannot be motivated by a punitive purpose. Nor can it be motivated by the desire to deter others from speaking,” Crawford wrote, while referencing the Red Scare and Palmer Raids of 1919 and McCarthyism in the 1950s. “Legal residents — not charged with crimes or misconduct — are being arrest-

ed and threatened with deportation for stating their views on the political issues of the day. ... The wheel of history has come around again.”

The judge added: “Mr. Mahdawi has raised a substantial claim that the government arrested him to stifle speech with which it disagrees. Such an act would be a violation of the Constitution — quite separate from the removal procedures followed by the immi-

MAHDAWI, Page A6

College sticker price can be misleading

And that may stop some from even applying

By Diti Kohli

GLOBE STAFF

At universities, the academic year ends with a familiar routine: Professors grade final exams. Students pack up their dorms. Universities announce tuition for the next year, almost inevitably higher than the year before.

Those never-ending increases mean that many Americans believe a four-year college degree is so exorbitantly expensive they cannot afford it, which — some research indicates — deters students from pursuing higher education.

There is some truth to that: The cost of attending a private university exceeds the median income of a household in the United States (\$80,610), and Americans suffer under loads of

debt, around \$1.7 trillion and growing, in pursuit of college degrees.

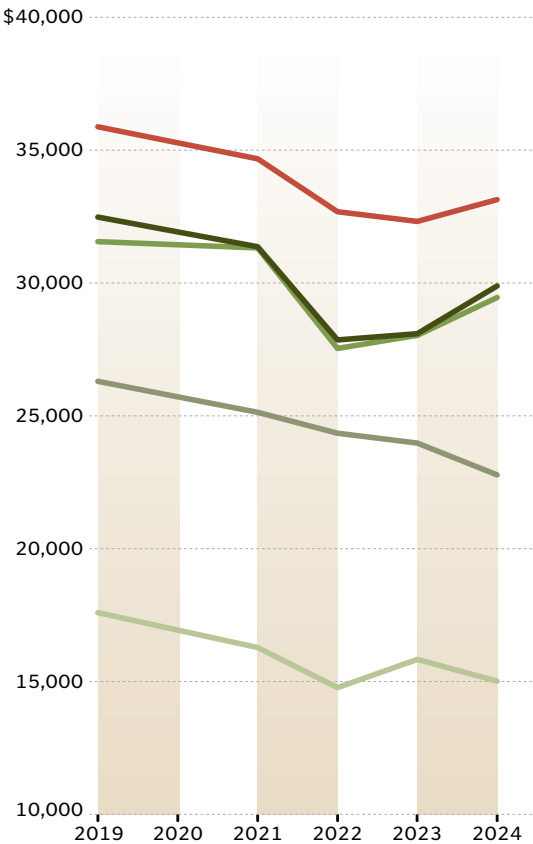
But postsecondary education, while not low-cost by any means, is often not as extreme as it seems. More than half of the public overestimates the actual cost of college, according to a survey in November from the Strada Education Foundation, a college and career coaching nonprofit. One in five survey participants overshot the cost of attendance by at least 20 percent.

It’s an easy mistake to make. The gap between the price colleges advertise and what students end up paying has widened with time. American households that earn the least generally also pay the least for college; those that earn the most pay the most. For all students, though, the average net cost of college — what families ultimately pay out of pocket — decreased this year at both pub-

COLLEGE COSTS, Page A10

Net cost of public flagship and research universities, by family income, adjusted for inflation

Family earning \$240,000 Family earning \$135,000
Family earning \$80,000 Family earning \$40,000
Posted sticker price



SOURCE: The Brookings Institution

KIRKLAND AN/GLOBE STAFF

Trump deflects blame for economy

Numbers show contraction in first quarter

By Matt Viser and Theodor Meyer

WASHINGTON POST

President Trump lashed out Wednesday morning at increasingly dim economic forecasts that have cast his policies in a harsh light and clouded what he had hoped would be a valedictory marker of his 100 days in office. He has blamed the Feder-

►The economic numbers are not encouraging, writes Larry Edelman. D1.

al Reserve. He has expressed anger at what he has described as unfair trade policies of the past, and bluntly said that Americans may have to stomach paying more and getting less. And, more than anything, he has blamed his predecessor.

“You probably saw some numbers today,” he said at the start of a Cabinet meeting at the White House. “And I have to start off by saying, that’s Biden; that’s not Trump.”

It was an echo of a social media post a few hours earlier — “This is Biden’s Stock Market, not Trump’s,” he

ECONOMY, Page A7

‘Science will shrink’ with funding cuts, experts say

Cite years of work halted as federal money dries up

By Jason Laughlin, Neena Hagen, Kay Lazar, and Liz Kowalczyk

GLOBE STAFF

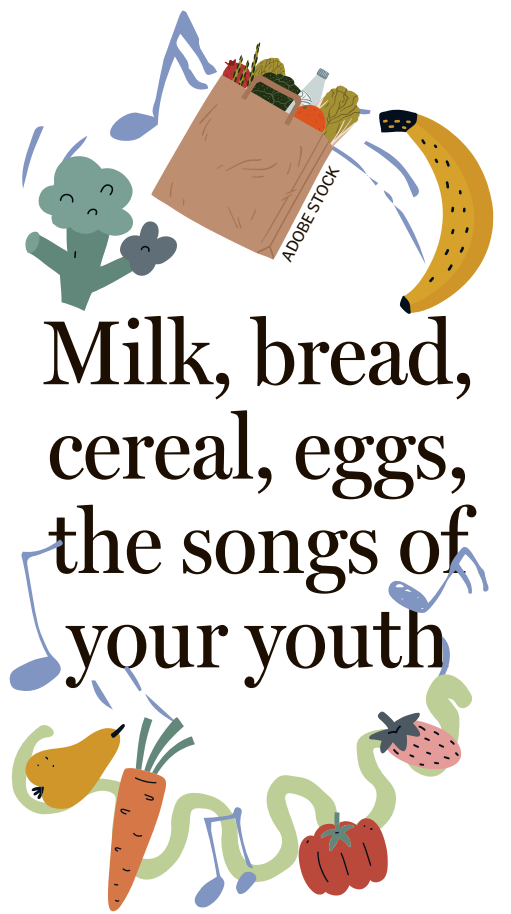
In the short space of a few months, President Trump has undercut seven decades of federal support for scientific research, transforming a pillar of academia and industry in New England, perhaps permanently.

From the start, Trump sought to excise diversity and gender issues from the federal government by taking a sledgehammer to billions in government funding. But at the close of his first 100 days in office, it’s clear his approach is having consequences far beyond his ideological targets, kneecapping swaths of health-related work with only tenuous connections to diversity or gender.

Among the casualties in New England are research into cancer prevention, substance use treatment, and countering misinformation. Public health programs related to vaccinations, mental health, and disease tracking are at risk, too. Careers in medical and health research, or in the government agencies established to foster scientific inquiry, have likely been cut short. It may never be fully clear how much what Trump has done will slow, or even prevent, critically important discoveries.

“I do think science will shrink,” said Brandon Ogbunu, a professor in the Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology at Yale University, during a Globe-hosted panel discussion

HEALTH, Page A6



Milk, bread, cereal, eggs, the songs of your youth

A former bagger plays off popularity of Market Basket’s music

By Beth Teitell

GLOBE STAFF

DANVERS — The best place to meet Bob Hoyt is probably at the Danvers Market Basket, or, as his girlfriend calls it, his “emotional support” store.

Hoyt, who is now 37, does contract work for a mulch-coloring company. But the reason he was perched on a bench outside his happy place on a recent afternoon — scanning the parking lot for the reporter who would tell the world his story — is rooted in 2002.

That story? It’s about a man who’s curating a playlist made up of songs piped over the sound system of the grocery store he worked at when he was 14.

The playlist, “Market Basket Classics,” is on Spotify, where it has a robust 25 hours worth of songs, and a loving description that reads “one-hit wonders” and “clunky 80’s hits.”

Behind the music is a former bagger with two dreams: To make a playlist so good that it triggers nostalgia no matter when you were born, and to have that list endorsed by no less a musical icon than Market Basket itself.

“If the playlist led to recognition from the corporate team ...” Hoyt said, both giddy at the prospect and afraid of sounding presumptuous, since his cur-

MARKET BASKET, Page A10

Place in the clouds

Thursday: Gray.
High: 58-63. Low: 49-54.
Friday: Showers.
High: 71-76. Low: 56-61.
Sunrise: 5:39 Sunset: 7:44
Comics and Weather, **D5-6**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

The Supreme Court appeared open to allowing Oklahoma to use government money to run the nation’s first religious charter school. A2.

Milton voters approved a \$9.5 million tax increase to solve a deficit in next year’s town and school budgets. **B1.**

US, Ukraine seal deal

The United States and Ukraine announced the creation of a new reconstruction and investment fund, formalizing an economic agreement between the two countries that is intended to give the United States access to proceeds from Ukraine’s reserves of rare earth minerals. The agreement is intended to provide Ukraine with an implicit security arrangement while addressing President Trump’s concerns that the United States has provided Kyiv with a blank check. **A3.**



VOL. 307, NO. 121

Suggested retail price
\$4.00